

SCITI 2026

Smart City Thailand Index

Reality, not ribbon-cutting.

Digital Economy Promotion Agency (depa)

Ministry of Digital Economy and Society (MDES)

Kingdom of Thailand

SLIC (Smart Liveable Cities Index) Methodology

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Pronounced "City" (silent S, like Latin)

1. Executive Summary

Thailand has certified 37 smart cities across 4 batches since 2019. But how many of them actually work? This index exists because the gap between announcements and outcomes needed measuring. We score cities on what citizens experience on the ground — not what got presented on a slide deck.

118 cities tracked. 39 operational. 15 Alpha tier. Built on SLIC methodology with 7 weighted pillars: Livability (25%), Economy (20%), Safety (15%), Wellbeing (15%), Environment (10%), Hospitality (10%), Digital (5%).

The scoring formula: $Composite = \frac{\sum(Pillar \times Weight)}{\sum(Weights)}$. Each pillar is scored 0-100 from verifiable public data sources. Tier assignment is automatic: Alpha ≥ 65 , Beta 45-64, Gamma < 45 .

2. Top 10 Cities

Rank	City	Province	Score	Tier
1	Phuket Smart City	Phuket	72.8	Alpha
2	Samyan Smart City	Bangkok	72.4	Alpha
3	Chiang Mai Smart Old Town	Chiang Mai	71.1	Alpha
4	Khon Kaen Smart City	Khon Kaen	70.2	Alpha
5	CMU Smart City	Chiang Mai	70.1	Alpha
6	Saensuk Smart City	Chon Buri	67.5	Alpha
7	Phra Ram 4 Smart City	Bangkok	66.9	Alpha
8	Krabi Smart City	Krabi	66.5	Alpha
9	Chachoengsao Smart City	Chachoengsao	66.4	Alpha
10	Hat Yai Smart City	Songkhla	66.1	Alpha

3. Scoring Methodology

Seven pillars, each scored 0-100 from verifiable public data:

Pillar	Weight	Key Signals
Livability	25%	Housing, transit, infrastructure, utilities
Economy	20%	Jobs, GPP per capita, growth, affordability
Safety	15%	Crime rate, disaster resilience, road safety
Wellbeing	15%	Healthcare, education, mental health
Environment	10%	Air quality (PM2.5), green space, water, waste
Hospitality	10%	Culture, community, belonging, tourism

Tier classification: Alpha ≥ 65 (operational) | Beta 45-64 (building) | Gamma < 45 (planning)

4. Data Sources (15+)

- NSO — population, income, employment
- NESDC — Gross Provincial Product per capita
- PCD — PM2.5 from 70+ stations
- GISTDA — satellite green coverage
- World Bank — GDP growth, Gini
- ADB — infrastructure finance
- Open-Meteo / Copernicus — climate
- Royal Thai Police — crime stats
- DOPA — population registry
- depa citydata.in.th — IoT, engagement
- MOPH — hospital beds
- BOI — FDI, investment
- ONEP — environmental index
- Royal Forest Dept — forest cover
- Field observation — direct site verification

5. Financial Toolkit (15 instruments)

Based on ASEAN Smart City Financing Toolkit, ADB ACGF, Thailand SEC Green Bond Framework, BOI S-Curve:

- PPP (500M-10B+)
- Green Bond (1-20B)
- Land Value Capture (200M-5B)
- Municipal Bond (500M-5B)
- BOT (200M-5B)
- ADB/JICA/WB Dev Finance
- Blended Finance (100M-5B)
- BOI Incentives
- Gov Transfer (5-200M)
- TA Grant (1-50M)
- Crowdfunding (100K-10M)
- On-Bill Financing
- Smart City SEZ (5B-100B+)
- Land Pooling (200M-2B)

- Asset Recycling (500M-10B)

6. Standards Alignment

- UN-Habitat CPI
- ISO 37122:2019
- SDG 11
- ASEAN Smart Cities Framework 2018
- ASCAP 2021-2025
- New Urban Agenda 2016
- Thailand PPP Act B.E. 2562 (2019)